

6 SHOPPING



The quickest way to know a woman is to go shopping with her.

Marcelene Cox

If men liked shopping, they'd call it research.

Cynthia Nelms

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **reasons for shopping:** favourite/pleasant/enjoyable activity, waste of time, useless, necessity, hunting for bargains
- **trading activities:** to do the shopping, to buy, to purchase, to negotiate the price, to haggle over a price, to queue, to stand in a line, to go on a shopping trip, to go on a shopping spree, to go window shopping, to run a shop, to sell, to retail, to wholesale
- **people in trade:**
 - shop assistant, retailer, wholesaler, cashier
 - customer, bargain hunter, window shopper
- **ways of shopping:** *direct sale:* market, small specialised shops, large shopping centres, *indirect sale:* mail order, door-to-door selling, hire purchase, catalogue sale, online sale
- **ways of payment:** in cash, by bank card (credit card/debit card), by cheque (AmE: check), hire purchase (in instalments), electronic forms of payment (Internet banking), direct bank transfer, postal payment, invoice
- **prices:** expensive, unbelievable, it costs a fortune, costly, reasonable, affordable, cut, half, full, reduced, low (decreased), high (increased)
 - prices go down/fall, drop in prices
 - prices go up, rise in prices
- **in the shops (AmE: stores):** cash desk, shopping cart, shopping basket, shopping bag, shopping list
- **goods:** out of stock, warehouse, in short supply, price-tag, care label, on sale, clearance
- **small specialised shops:** grocer's, baker's, ironmonger's, butcher's, stationer's, greengrocer's, corner shop, bookshop, shoe shop, boutique, clothes shop, shoe shop, gift shop, chemist's (AmE: drugstore), DIY stores, pet shop, delicatessen, coffee shop, off-licence, tobacconist's, confectioner's, gift shop, junk shop, toy shop, newsagent's, florist's
- **larger shopping centres:** supermarket, department stores, hypermarket, shopping malls, chain stores
- **other ways of shopping:** mail order, door-to-door selling, hire purchase
- **customers' preferences:** personal contact with shop assistants, fresh foodstuffs, a wide choice of goods, reasonable prices, sales, bargains, everything is under one roof, free parking, shopping bags for free, payment by credit card
- **advertisements (adverts/ads):** intention, potential customers, consumers, promoting goods and brands
- **market:** exported and imported products, domestic goods, offer and request, supporting your/one's own economy, credit crunch, financial crisis

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Is shopping a pleasant activity or a waste of time for you? Explain.
2. What kind of shops are there in the area where you live?
3. What kinds of shops do you like going to? Why?
4. Are you thrifty or a big spender? Explain.
5. How often do you buy clothes?
6. Do you ever buy things via the Internet? Why?
7. What is the most expensive thing you have ever bought? Was it worth it?
8. Can people become addicted to shopping?
9. Given the choice, would you rather buy imported or domestic products? Why?
10. Is it common in your country to haggle over a price when shopping?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

WAYS OF BUYING AND SELLING

Shopping is an activity that is enjoyed by many people. There are also people who hate shopping and say that it is a **waste of time**. Love it or hate it, shopping is necessary to buy the things you need.

Apart from **direct sale**, it is also gradually becoming popular to buy goods by **mail order**. This includes buying things through a catalogue or **via** the Internet. Slovaks mostly use the Internet to buy books, electronics, clothes as well as products that they cannot find in shops. **Door-to-door selling** is less popular in our country. More and more people get things by **hire purchase**, which means that they only pay a part of the **required amount of money** for the goods they have chosen and afterwards pay regular **instalments**. Otherwise, we can **pay** for goods and services **in cash** or **by bank card**. **Paying by cheque** (AmE: checks) is still the most popular form of payment in the USA. However, it is very **rare** in Europe since it was replaced by electronic forms of payment and **direct bank transfers**. **Postal payment** in Slovakia is gradually **disappearing**.

1. What ways of buying and selling are mentioned in the text above?
2. How can we pay for goods?

SMALL SPECIALISED SHOPS

There are many kinds of shops **ranging** from large **shopping malls**, **department stores** and supermarkets to small **specialised shops**, such as a **grocer's**, a **baker's**, an **ironmonger's**, a **butcher's**, a **stationer's**, a **greengrocer's**, a **chemist's**, a bookshop, a shoe shop and a boutique. A **grocery store**, more often called a corner shop, can be found locally in most towns and cities. It sells a wide variety of foodstuffs. They also have dairy products, such as milk, butter, cream, cheese and yoghurts. They normally sell newspapers and magazines as well. Fresh bread, **rolls**, **buns** and **pastries** can be bought at a baker's. Butchers sell meat including pork, **beef**, **lamb**, **poultry**, **venison**, **mutton**, smoked ham, sausages and **frankfurters**. People who like gardening and doing some do-it-yourself work around the house frequently need some **hardware**. They can go to an ironmonger's to buy **hammers**, **pliers**, **nails**, **saws**, axes and other **tools** and materials. Larger hardware shops are called DIY stores. Writing paper, wrapping paper, **envelopes**, notebooks, pens, pencils, **scissors**, **crayons**, **glue**, rubber and **rulers** are sold at stationer's shops. Fresh vegetables and all kinds of fruit can be bought at a greengrocer's. Many people prefer shopping at the market, where they can **haggle over a price**. A chemist's is a specialised shop where people can buy medicines. In Britain, a chemist's also **sells** cosmetics and toiletries, such as make-up, **shaving-cream**, **razor blades**, shampoo, soap and toothbrushes. **Boutiques** sell dresses, shirts, skirts, blouses, pullovers, trousers, sweaters, cardigans, jeans and also **stockings** and **scarves**.

3. What kinds of specialised shops are mentioned by the writer?
4. What kind of products are sold in corner shops?

LARGE SHOPPING CENTRES

A supermarket is a large **self-service** grocery shop. It also sells some other products such as clothes or **household appliances**. **Chain stores** are shops with **branches** all over the country owned by one company. The most popular British chain stores are *Marks&Spencer*, *H&M* and *Next* which sell clothes and fashion accessories at quite **affordable** prices. Department stores are large buildings, usually several storeys high. They have many departments which offer their customers all kinds of foodstuffs, clothes, shoes, toys, sporting goods, **leather goods**, cleaning supplies and cosmetics, household appliances, books and **furniture** all under one roof. The world-famous department stores **include** *Selfridge's* and *Harrods* in London and *Macy's* in New York. A hypermarket is a big store which combines a supermarket and a department store. A wide variety of products are sold under one roof, such as clothes, household appliances and furniture. These days, a lot of Slovaks do their weekly shopping in a hypermarket. Hypermarkets are usually situated outside cities and are **surrounded** by large car parks. Some are even open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week – 24/7. A shopping mall is a large indoor shopping centre that **contains** many different types of stores. These shops are often open for much longer hours, including evenings and Sundays. Shopping malls have **cafés**, snack bars or restaurants, where people can relax when they are tired of shopping. They also have

cinemas, wellness centres and children's **play areas**, where children can play while their parents do the shopping.

5. Which types of large shopping centres are mentioned by the writer?
6. What are the most popular British chain stores?

ADVERTISING GOODS AND PRODUCTS

Nowadays more and more customers prefer shopping in hypermarkets, department stores or shopping malls to shopping in small specialised shops. It is very difficult for small specialised stores to **compete** with them and that is why a lot of small shops close down as a result. People who prefer small shops say that the goods are fresher (if they are food products), and the contact with the **shop assistants** is much more personal. They also do not spend too much time shopping. **On the other hand**, big stores have a **wider choice** of goods, usually at cheaper prices. People often buy things **in a sale** to save money. Big shopping centres are often **criticised** because they **encourage** a **consumer society** – **extensive advertising** and media influence. They produce so-called shopaholics who cannot **resist** spending money and often buy things that they do not need. **Commercial advertisements** are **intended** to **persuade** potential customers to **purchase** a particular **brand**. This is achieved by regular repetition of the product's name, brand and supposed qualities to influence the **minds** of consumers. **Promoting goods** is done via media, such as newspapers, magazines, radio, television, the Internet and by mail.

7. Why are large shopping centres often criticised?
8. What are the advantages and disadvantages of shopping in small specialised shops and in large shopping centres?

IMPORT – EXPORT

Slovakia imports a lot of products from different countries from all over the world and exports mainly **vehicles**, **machinery**, electrical **equipment**, metal, chemicals and plastic. Slovak customers are encouraged to buy **domestic products** which are often of better quality than imported ones and available for **reasonable** prices. Buying domestic products has a positive effect on **supply** and **demand** in our market which supports our own economy.

9. Which products does Slovakia export to different countries?
10. Why should we purchase domestic products rather than imported ones?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

affordable [ə'fɔ:dəbl] – prijateľný
baker's – pekáreň
beef – hovädzina
boutique – butik
branch – pobočka, filiálka
brand – značka
bun [bʌn] – žemľa
butcher's [bʊtʃəs] – mäsiarstvo
café [kæfeɪ] – kaviareň
chain store [tʃeɪn stɔ:] – obchodný reťazec
chemist's – lekárneň, drogeria
commercial advertisement [kəmɜ:ʃl əd'vɜ:tɪsmənt] – komerčná reklama
to compete with [kəm'pi:t] – konkurovať
consumer society [sə'saɪətɪ] – konzumná spoločnosť
to contain – obsahovať
crayon [kreɪən] – pastelka
demand – dopyt
department store – obchodný dom
direct bank transfer – priamy bankový prevod
direct sale – priamy predaj
to disappear – zmiznúť
domestic product – domáci výrobok
door-to-door selling – podomový predaj
to encourage – povzbudiť
envelope – obálka
equipment – vybavenie, zariadenie
extensive advertising [ɪkstənsɪv ədvətaɪzɪŋ] – rozsiahla reklama
frankfurter – párkok
furniture – nábytok
glue [glu:] – lepidlo
greengrocer's – obchod so zeleninou a ovocím
grocer's – potraviny
grocery store – obchod s potravinami
hammer – kladivo
hardware – železiarsky tovar
hire purchase [haɪə pɜ:tʃəs] – kúpa na splátky
household appliance [haʊshəʊld ə'plaɪəns] – domáci spotrebič
to include – zahrňovať
instalment – splátka
to intend – určiť, venovať
ironmonger's [aɪənmaŋgəz] – železiarstvo
lamb [læm] – jahňacina
leather goods – kožený tovar

machinery – stroje
mail order – zásielkový predaj
mind – myseľ
mutton [mʌtən] – baranina
nail – klinec
pastry [peɪstri] – pečivo
to persuade – presvedčiť
play area – priestor na hranie
pliers [plaɪəz] – kliešte
poultry [pəʊltri] – hydina
postal payment – poštová platba
to purchase [pɜ:tʃəs] – kúpiť
to range – byť v rozmedzí
rare [rɜə] – zriedkavý
razor blade [reɪzə bleɪd] – žiletka na holenie
reasonable – rozumný
to resist – odolať
roll – rohlík
roof – strecha
ruler – pravítko
saw [sɔ:] – píla
scarf (pl. scarves) – šatka, šál
scissors [sɪzəz] – nožnice
self-service – samoobsluha
shaving-cream – pena na holenie
shopping mall – nákupné centrum
specialised shop (AmE: specialized) [speʃəlaɪzd] – špecializovaný obchod
stationer's [steɪʃənəz] – papiernictvo
stockings – pančuchy
supply [sə'plaɪ] – zásoba
surrounded (by) – obklopený
tool [tu:l] – náradie
vehicle [vi:ɪkl] – auto, dopravný prostriedok
venison [venɪsn] – jelenie mäso
via [vaɪə] – prostredníctvom
waste of time – strata času
wider choice (of) – širší výber

to haggle over a price – zjednávať cenu
in a sale – vo výpredaji
on the other hand – na druhej strane
to pay by bank card – (za)platiť kartou
to pay by cheque – (za)platiť šekom
to pay in cash – (za)platiť v hotovosti
to promote goods – propagovať tovar
required amount of money – požadovaná suma peňazí

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Which specialised shops sell the following goods?



greengrocer's – ironmonger's – ~~corner shop~~ – shoe shop – gift shop –
 tobacconist's – clothes shop – chemist's – off-licence – bookshop – pet
 shop – confectioner's – butcher's – baker's – florist's – delicatessen –
 – stationer's – junk shop – coffee shop

Example: flour, oil, eggs, sweets, coffee, yoghurt corner shop

1. doughnuts, buns, rolls, bread, muffins, bagels _____
2. sausages, bacon, frankfurters, pork, lamb _____
3. beans, lettuce, pineapples, tomatoes, cabbages _____
4. staples, pencils, glue, stickers, envelopes _____
5. body lotion, soap, films, pain killers, razors _____
6. nails, hammers, saws, pipes, hooks, axes _____
7. boots, slippers, socks, shoe laces, insoles _____
8. cardigans, skirts, blouses, scarves, dressing gowns _____
9. cigarettes, matches, cigars, pipes, lighters _____
10. beer, champagne, crisps, lemonade, wine _____
11. aquaria, gerbils, fish food, mice, spiders _____
12. salami, bagels, pâté, cooked meat _____

Task 2 Match shop assistant's questions with customer's answers.

A

Example: Hello. May I help you? a

1. Is it OK? _____
2. Do you like it? _____
3. Shall I get you something else? _____
4. How much is it? _____
5. How do you want to pay? _____
6. Do you want to try it on? _____
7. What colour would you like? _____
8. What size are you? _____
9. Are you looking for something specific? _____
10. Do you have this T-shirt in red? _____

B

- a) Hello. I'm looking for a blouse.
- b) It's 50 €.
- c) Navy blue, please.
- d) By credit card, please.
- e) Well, I don't know. I am not used to stripes.
- f) I think I am a 38.
- g) Yes, please. Where are the fitting rooms?
- h) Yes. It's just my size. It fits me well.
- i) No, thanks. That's all.
- j) I'm afraid we don't.
- k) Yes. I'd like to get a jumper that would match these trousers.